WEEK 6 · LECTURE L3 OF 3 · UNIT II

Course Correction and the D1 Clinic

When to scale, fix, retrain or pause, and what Deliverable 1 got right and wrong.

Part 1	Four options after go-live: scale, fix integration, retrain, pause
Part 2	Why projects that should stop keep going
Part 3	D1 clinic: where Round 3 data contradict a Round 2 choice
Read	Your pod's D1 and Round 3 submission

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PART 1 · FOUR OPTIONS

After go-live, choose the response that fits the evidence

Option	Choose it when	At GreenLeaf
Scale	Use is high and problems are minor	Laptop users: 98.6% active use
Fix integration	Use is high but data are re-keyed or duplicated	Two HRIS hold the same people
Retrain	People have access but lack know-how	Literacy score 2 users with a smartphone
Pause	Access or design blocks use entirely	Feature phone users: 0% active use

THE RULE

Training does not fix access. Fixing access does not fix a bad process. Match the response to the barrier.

PART 2 · DECIDE IN ADVANCE

Set the scale, fix or stop rule before the pilot starts

The metric

One measure that shows success, such as weekly active use among Tier 3 staff.

The threshold

The number that triggers each decision, written down before results arrive.

The owner

The person who must act on the result, with authority to stop.

WHY

Once money and reputations are invested, people defend the project instead of reading the data. A rule set in advance protects the decision.

PART 3 · D1 CLINIC

Questions to ask of your own Blueprint

Question	What a strong Blueprint does
Which system is the single record?	Names one, and retires the duplicate with a date
Who does the stack reach first?	Shows reach for Tier 3, smartphone-only staff, not only head office
What did Round 3 data change?	Revises the plan where adoption contradicted it
Is every claim backed by a figure?	Cites the tab and column, at full scale for the Board

THE HABIT A Blueprint that never changes after new evidence was not a plan. It was a hope.

Going deeper: the theory underneath course correction

The next slides set out escalation of commitment, the sunk cost effect, stage-gate decisions, and real options: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · STAW (1976)

We throw good money after bad

THE CORE IDEA

Escalation of commitment: people who made a failing decision invest more to justify it.

HOW IT WORKS

Personal responsibility for the first choice raises the urge to continue after bad news.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Sometimes persistence is right; the problem is persistence that ignores evidence.

AT GREENLEAF

The pod that chose a tool in Round 2 is the pod least able to see it failing in Round 3. Invite outside review.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ARKES AND BLUMER (1985)

Sunk costs should not drive decisions

THE CORE IDEA

Money already spent cannot be recovered, yet people let it shape future choices.

HOW IT WORKS

Decisions should compare future costs and benefits only. Past spending is irrelevant to what comes next.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Sunk costs can carry information about commitment and reputation, so the rule is not absolute.

AT GREENLEAF

PeopleCloud's licenses are already paid. The only question is whether future spending on it is the best use of money.

THEORY IN DEPTH · COOPER (1990)

Stage-gate: decide at each gate whether to continue

THE CORE IDEA

Projects move through stages separated by gates where leaders decide go, kill, hold or recycle.

HOW IT WORKS

Each gate has criteria set in advance and a decision owner.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Too many gates can slow change and reward paperwork over learning.

AT GREENLEAF

Treat each round's adoption data as a gate. Write the criteria for go, fix or stop before the data arrive.

THEORY IN DEPTH · DIXIT AND PINDYCK (1994); MCGRATH (1999)

Small bets keep options open

THE CORE IDEA

Real options thinking: a pilot buys the right, not the obligation, to scale later.

HOW IT WORKS

Spend a little to learn; scale only when the evidence is good. Uncertainty makes the option more valuable.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Options are hard to value precisely, and pilots can drag on without ever deciding.

AT GREENLEAF

A Telugu WhatsApp leave flow in Warangal stores is a cheap option. A firm-wide launch gives the option away.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

Match the response to the barrier: scale, fix, retrain or pause.

2

Write decision rules before the results arrive.

3

A plan that never changes after evidence is a hope, not a plan.

NEXT Unit III: people analytics foundations.